Coolfont, 4 December 1977

Dear Mountainside Association Members,

In place of a fall newsletter I would like to write personally to introduce the new officers of the Association, to inform you of our plans for the coming year, and to explain the rationale for the increases in assessments for the fiscal year 1978 (1 October '77 to 30 September '78).

There are two holdovers from the previous slate of officers: Carol Green (Tel. 301-654-7737) as Secretary and Rol Capen (Tel. 304-258-1636) as Chairman of the Coolfont Foundation Committee. It was hoped that one of the elected Board members would assume that responsibility and assist Mrs. Capen in her additional capacity as Foundation Artistic Director but that was not possible at this time. There is a new Board member designated by the Development Co.: Martha Ashelman (Tel. 304-258-1213). She replaces Randy Ashelman as Board member and Sam Ashelman as Vice President. The most demanding office, that of Treasurer/ Chairman of the Budget and Maintenance Committee, was assumed by Betty Fiske (Tel. 304-258-3550). She will be assisted in an advisory capacity by William Spiegel (Tel. 304-258-1692). Mr. Spiegel will also assist the new Chairman of the Recreational Facilities Committee, Charles Eddy (Tel. 202-667-1926). Due to the demands of his job Lincoln Cathers (Tel. 301-365-8154) resigned as president but agreed to serve this coming year as Chairman of the Development and Architectural Control Committee.

As to goals, in light of the fact that the assessments are rapidly going from token payments to substantial sums, the Board feels that its first priority is to establish better cost accounting and financial control procedures. With this in mind we have asked the treasurer to draw up a job description for parttime professional assistance and to recommend individuals. This person's chief task would be to keep our books and to supply the Board with a quarterly financial statement. Our next priority is the water problem. Although the Ad Hoc Water Committee has not yet submitted its final recommendations it is agreed by all that the system needs regular, professional monitoring. In response the Board has engaged, on a three-month trial basis, the Development Co. to begin a twice-weekly monitoring of the system, effective Wednesday, 7 December. If this should prove mutually satisfactory the Board expects to contract with CDC for this service on an annual basis. Of all the items in the assessment, that for recreation is the most controversial. In response to this the Board will undertake a complete review of this assessment and expects to make recommendations in the spring. And finally to encourage greater participation by members in the duties of the Association the Board will entertain proposals to award service with some sort of compensation, such as reduced assessments. In addition we will examine the possibility of reserving one of the six elected board seats for non-homeowners.

As to the rationale for the approximately 22% increase in assessments, the Board acted to offset inflation and to build up adequate reserves. (An additional $10 was added to the water assessment to pay for the cost of monitoring the water system for the three-month trial period.) Please remember that, should the Board after thoroughly reviewing our financial situation, consider this level of assessment justified, it is constrained by the vote of the recent annual meeting to limit automatic increases to an average of 10% for the next two years.

In concluding this long letter, the Board strongly encourages greater participation in the affairs of the Association by all members and welcomes comments, criticisms and suggestions. The tentative date for the next Board meeting is 18 February 1978 and it will be open to all members as always. In the meantime please feel free to call any member of the Board.

May I end with some personal remarks? My wife and I were attracted to Coolfont by both the natural setting and the people. Unfortunately so far we've seen more of the former than the latter. We plan to be here most holiday weekends starting with Christmas. We hope to have more of you as guests in our home and, in turn, hope you will think of us when you plan get-togethers. As a start we would like as many of you as possible to drop by our house (H-8) for conversation and refreshments Christmas Day, Sunday afternoon between 2 and 5 pm.

Best wishes to all in the New Year,

Elmer Broxson (em.)

Elmer Broxson, President
Coolfont Mountainside Association

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P.S. For those who would like to pay the assessments in calendar year 1977, the rates approved by the Board at its meeting on 3 December are: lot only $85 ($60 roads and $25 recreation) and house $365 ($120 roads, $125 recreation, $70 water and $50 Sewer). The regular bills will go out the first week of January 1978.